

IRAQ

Iraq: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Full Name	Republic of Iraq
Short Form	Iraq
Capital	Baghdad
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Federal Parliamentary Republic
President	Abdul Latif Rashid (as of 2025)
Prime Minister	Mohammed Shia' Al Sudani (as of 2025)
Currency	Iraqi Dinar (IQD)
UN Member Since	21 December 1945
Permanent UNSC Member	No
MUN Standing	Strategically critical Middle Eastern state, post-conflict recovery, oil exporter, focus on security and reconstruction

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
The Shi'is of Iraq	Yitzhak Nakash	Detailed on Iraq's majority sect and politics
Iraq: A Political History	Adeed Dawisha	Comprehensive political history
The Iraqi Conflict: Origins and Consequences	Faleh A. Jabar & Hosham Dawod	Covers recent political and security issues
Iraq and the United Nations: Conflict and Cooperation	Bassem A. Ghazzi	Iraq's UN relations and peacekeeping

Human Rights in Iraq: Challenges and Prospects	International Crisis Group	Analysis of human rights challenges
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Research Table: Iraq & the UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
Iraq National UPR Report (PDF)	Iraq National UPR Report	Iraq's comprehensive self-assessment under the 4th UPR cycle, detailing progress and challenges across justice, gender, environment, displacement (refworld.org , iraq.un.org).
UN DPPA – Climate & Conflict Desk Study (PDF)	Climate, Peace & Security in Iraq	Highlights how drought, water scarcity, and climate-induced migration fuel instability—key for UNHRC environmental rights agenda .
UN Working Group on Business & Human Rights (PDF)	Report: WG on Business & Human Rights	Reviews corporate accountability and labor-exploitation protocols in Iraq, vital for UNHRC's business & rights theme .
UNDESA – Iraq VNR SDGs Report (PDF)	Iraq 2021 VNR SDGs Report	Links human rights with social development goals—useful for UNHRC intersectional SDG discussions .
US State Department – Iraq 2023 HR Report (PDF)	Iraq 2023 Human Rights Report	Latest overview on civil & political rights, justice, religion, labor, and refugee issues—covers the full UNHRC agenda .

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Human Rights Watch	HRW UPR Submission (July 2024)	Covers death penalty, torture, enforced disappearances, protests — essential for civil political & justice reforms (hrw.org , hrw.org)
HRW	HRW Submission to UN HRC (Jan 2022)	Details accountability failures for ISIS crimes and protester deaths — vital for accountability agenda

HRW	<u>HRW UPR Submission (Mar 2014)</u>	Documents gender-based detention abuse — critical for women's rights and fair trial discussions
UPR-Info	<u>Iraq UPR Info Page</u>	Central hub for official documents and stakeholder submissions across multiple UN agendas
UN	<u>UNAMI Protest Crackdown Report (2019)</u>	Summarizes UNAMI investigation on excessive force & mass arrests of protesters
GICJ	<u>Mid-Term UPR Assessment (2010)</u>	Evaluates implementation gaps of UPR commitments — essential for follow-up accountability
OHCHR (UN Digital Library)	<u>GA Resolution on Iraq (2000 PDF)</u>	Official GA condemnation of human rights violations — provides historical UN context
OHCHR (UN Digital Library)	<u>GA Resolution on Iraq (1996 PDF)</u>	Earlier formal censure on torture, disappearances, and due process failures
Refworld	<u>UK FCO Human Rights & Democracy Report 2015</u>	Assesses ISIS-era abuses, displacement, and justice challenges — good historical span
UN News	<u>UNAMI Human Rights Update (2012)</u>	Highlights judicial abuses, torture, and restricted freedoms under OHCHR oversight
Documentary	<u>"On Her Shoulders" (2018)</u>	Story of Yazidi genocide survivor — supports genocide/crimes agenda and gender rights
Global Detention Project	<u>Iraq Detention Practices</u>	Covers arbitrary detention, IDPs, refugee camps — critical to detention agenda
HRW	<u>HRW Iraq UPR Outcome (Mar 2020)</u>	Covers protest violence, due process, Yazidi survivors — useful evaluation source
OHCHR	<u>"Present Situation of Human Rights in Iraq" (2004 PDF)</u>	Early UN analysis post-2003 — adds historical depth for ongoing rights patterns

Unique Aspects: Iraq in the UNHRC Landscape

1. **High-Execution Rates & Judicial Flaws:** With around 8,000 people on death row, the mass executions in Iraq really shine a light on the serious failures in due process and the troubling risk of torture within the legal system.
2. **Protest Crackdown Accountability Gaps:** Since 2019, over 560 protesters have lost their lives, even with UNAMI reports highlighting the situation and only a handful of prosecutions taking place. This has become a key issue for accountability at the UNHRC.
3. **Systemic Use of Torture:** Reports from UNAMI and HRW shed light on the alarming issue of routine torture and coerced confessions, raising significant concerns about the effectiveness of the UNHRC's torture prevention efforts.
4. **Enforced Disappearances & High Missing Rates:** With nearly a million people unaccounted for—including many protestors—the absence of disappearance laws is hindering the UN's ability to uphold human rights obligations.
5. **ISIS-era War Crimes & Victim Reparations:** The ongoing application of terrorism laws for ISIS trials, rather than focusing on international crimes, is weakening accountability, as highlighted by the UNHRC's emphasis on the need for ICC involvement.
6. **Severe Gender-Based Abuses:** The documented instances of torture, female genital mutilation, and forced marriages shed light on serious violations of gender rights and the shortcomings of our justice system.
7. **Sectarian Violence & Militia Impunity:** Allegations of abduction and genocide against militias following the 2014 IMF campaigns highlight the urgent need for justice regulated by the UN Human Rights Council.
8. **Child Rights Impacted by Conflict:** Child labor, displacement, and internally displaced persons (IDPs) due to war highlight the crucial role of the UN Human Rights Council in safeguarding vulnerable youth.
9. **Weak Realization of UPR Recommendations:** The ongoing struggles to put UPR guidance into action highlight some deep-rooted issues with follow-through and the overall effectiveness of the UNHRC.
10. **Complex International Cooperation:** The foreign involvement after 2003, including militias and contractors, has made it even more challenging to

enforce human rights. The discussions around Saudi intervention and the use of mercenaries are hot topics in UN forums.

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